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NITTE (Deemed to be University)

(Established under Sec.(3) of UGC Act, 1956)

First Semester (CBCS) B.Tech Degree Examinations, Nov. - Dec. 2025**25HSS131– COMMUNICATIVE ENGLISH**

(For AER, AID, AIM, CBS, CSE, CIV, CYB, ECE, EEE, ISE, MEC, RAI, VDT)

Duration: 3 Hours]**[Max. Marks: 100****Note:**

Part – A: Multiple Choice Questions: Answer all **Twenty** questions in the **OMR Sheet** provided. Each question carries equal marks.

Part – B: Descriptive Answer Questions: Answer **Five full** questions, choosing **Two full** Questions from **Unit I and Unit II** each and **One full** question from **Unit III**.

PART - A: MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS**20 Marks**

1. The car is parked outside.
A) /ɑ:/ B) /ɔ:/
C) /ə/ D) /ɜ:/
2. The food on the table looks delicious.
A) /ʊ/ B) /u:/
C) /ɔ:/ D) /ə/
3. This page is full of advertisements.
A) /eɪ/ B) /aɪ/
C) /ɔɪ/ D) /iə/
4. The house has a beautiful garden.
A) /əʊ/ B) /aʊ/
C) /eə/ D) /ʊə/
5. I got a gift for my birthday.
A) /ɔ:/ B) /ʌ/
C) /ɒ/ D) /e/
6. She cut the paper with scissors.
A) /ə/ B) /ʌ/
C) /ɑ:/ D) /ɒ/
7. What would you say during a telephone conversation if you cannot hear the other person clearly?
A) Please speak louder. B) You are very quiet, please call later.
C) I did not understand what you said. Can you repeat, please? D) I am going to hang up now.
8. What would you say in a phone call if you had trouble understanding someone's last name?
A) I do not want to know your last name, thanks. B) What is your first name again?
C) I will call you later. D) Can you please spell your last name?
9. How would you politely request a stranger on the train to open the door?
A) Will you open the door now? B) Could you open the door, please?
C) Can you open the door right away? D) Why aren't you opening the door?
10. What would you say during a telephone conversation to politely ask a junior colleague to send you an email?
A) Can you send me an email? B) Could you please send me an email?
C) Will you send me an email? D) You should send me an email.
11. Which of the following is the most important means of communication?
A) Posture B) Language
C) Eye contact D) Gestures

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12. Which of the following gestures is commonly used as a formal greeting?
 A) Handshake B) Waving both hands
 C) Thumbs up D) Nodding with crossed arms
13. According to Ambedkar's speech, what is the central contradiction India will face starting January 26, 1950?
 A) Unification of all religious groups B) Complete equality in social, economic, and political life
 C) Political democracy alongside social and economic inequality D) The end of political democracy
14. According to R.K. Narayan, why is headache considered a blessing for mankind?
 A) It is a serious illness requiring immediate treatment B) It helps people avoid difficult or embarrassing situations
 C) It causes physical pain that teaches patience D) It encourages people to visit doctors frequently
15. What is the central theme of Wole Soyinka's 'Telephone Conversation'?
 A) Love and romance B) Friendship and trust
 C) History of Nigeria D) Racial discrimination and bias
16. Which theme is strongly emphasised in 'Coromandel Fishers' by Sarojini Naidu?
 A) Loneliness and isolation B) Wealth and luxury
 C) Courage and connection with nature D) Conflict and war
17. Call me _____ you need help.
 A) otherwise B) though
 C) nevertheless D) in case
18. Walk carefully _____ you will fall.
 A) despite B) in order to
 C) when D) or else
19. When Jane saw the fish swimming _____ the lake, she was thrilled.
 A) in B) on
 C) at D) besides
20. She was _____ in as the finance minister for the second time.
 A) sworn B) swore
 C) swear D) swearing

PART - B: DESCRIPTIVE ANSWER QUESTIONS

Unit – I		Marks	BT*	CO*	PO*
1	a) Transcribe the words into IPA and mark the Primary stress (i-iv) and transcribe the words in IPA into English (v-viii). i) Pen ii) Sun iii) Day iv) View v) /tʌf/ vi) /flaɪt/ vii) /prɒmpt/ viii) /en.dʒɪˈnɪə/	4	3	1	8,9,11
	b) Define Word Stress. Describe three common rules of word stress using examples.	4	2	1	8,9,11
	c) Explain any four barriers to communication.	4	1	2	8,9,11
	d) What are the key features that distinguish personal calls from business calls?	4	1	2	8,9,11
2	a) Transcribe the words into IPA and Mark the Primary Stress (i-iv) and transcribe the words in IPA into English (v-viii). i) no ii) fun iii) turn iv) ask v) /fɪːld/ vi) /ˈrɪːdə/ vii) /ˈjuːniən/ viii) /ˈʌŋkəl/	4	3	1	8,9,11

b)	What are the three main types of past tense markers, and write the rules for each type with examples?	4	1	1	8,9,11
c)	List out an appropriate Greeting message for each of the following:				
	i) Farewell to a colleague				
	ii) When someone is in the hospital				
	iii) On someone's death				
	iv) Someone leaving the country	4	1	2	8,9,11
d)	How would you say in each of these situations during a phone call?				
	i) Unable to hear well because of a bad line.				
	ii) You want him/ her to repeat something.				
	iii) He/she is speaking too fast.				
	iv) Difficulty in understanding the last name.	4	2	2	8,9,11
3 a)	Transcribe the words into IPA and Mark the Primary Stress (i-iv) and transcribe the words in IPA into English (v-viii).				
	i) Math ii) book iii) Shun iv) ring				
	v) /jæm/ vi) /jes/ vii) /'zi:əʊ/ viii) /'peɪ.pə/				
		4	3	1	8,9,11
b)	Identify whether the sentence has a British or American accent:				
	i. Please text me fast /fæst/.				
	ii. Shall we dance? /dɑ:ns/				
	iii. Where is your passport? /'pɑ:spɔ:t/				
	iv. The castle stood tall on the hill. /'kæsl/	4	4	1	8,9,11
c)	Summarise the features that distinguish spoken communication from written communication.	4	2	2	8,9,11
d)	Explain why telephone etiquette is important in professional communication.	4	2	2	8,9,11

Unit - II.

- 4 a) Read the following passage and answer the questions:

Power of Soft Skills

Hard skills may get a candidate an interview, but soft skills often determine employment. Imagine two equally qualified candidates vying for the same role at a prestigious company. Both have impressive backgrounds, technical skills, and work experience. When skills are equal, the key difference usually lies in soft skills — traits beyond technical ability that influence teamwork and leadership.

Soft skills like communication, critical thinking, empathy, teamwork, and active listening are essential for job performance and a balanced life. For example, an economist might excel at analysis but needs communication skills to be truly effective. A manager with an MBA must also show empathy and critical thinking to lead well. Both technical and soft skills are vital, with research indicating up to 85% of job success relates to soft skills. Those with strong soft skills often earn more and learn skills faster. They are key for career growth, resilience, and adapting to technological changes in the workforce.

The competitive job market highlights the importance of soft skills, which organizations value long before recent trends. Hiring often involves personality tests and teamwork questions, and soft skills influence promotions. They boost career growth, relationships, interests, and well-being, for instance, high emotional intelligence links to lower stress and anxiety. Consequently, soft skills development starts early, with students assessed on academics, interaction, and teamwork.

Governments from India, Singapore, Finland, and the UK have launched educational initiatives on emotional and social skills. Some people have natural soft skills, but others need effort as these skills develop differently from technical knowledge. Experts suggest starting with empathy, encouraging people to see others' perspectives. Effective communication involves body language, word choice, and tone—known as the three V's: visual, vocal, and verbal. Observing others and seeking feedback can improve soft skills, which can be honed over time. Soft skills are vital for professional success and enriching personal life.

- i) Name any two examples of soft skills mentioned in the passage.
 - ii) According to research, what percentage of job success is related to soft skills?
 - iii) Why are soft skills considered necessary when two candidates have equal technical qualifications?
 - iv) How do soft skills contribute to personal well-being according to the passage?
 - v) How have governments supported the development of soft skills according to the passage?
 - vi) Find a synonym for 'Renowned' from the passage?
 - vii) Identify an antonym for 'Uneven' from the passage?
 - viii) Give a one-word substitution for 'The ability to understand and share another person's feelings.'
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|--|--|---|---|---|--------|
| | | 8 | 3 | 3 | 8,9,11 |
|--|--|---|---|---|--------|
- 4 b) What does the use of 'headache' reveal about human behaviour and social attitudes in Narayan's Headache story?
- | | | | | | |
|--|--|---|---|---|--------|
| | | 4 | 2 | 3 | 8,9,11 |
|--|--|---|---|---|--------|
- c) Analyse how the tone and word choice reveal the caller's shift from politeness to sarcasm in the Telephone Conversation.
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|--|--|---|---|---|--------|
| | | 4 | 4 | 3 | 8,9,11 |
|--|--|---|---|---|--------|
- 5 a) Do as directed:
- Rewrite using suitable prepositions:
- i) College reopens ____ January after the Christmas holidays.
 - ii) They arrived ____ the station.
- Rewrite using suitable articles:
- iii) He is ____ engineer working in Bengaluru.
 - iv) She is reading ____ book you lent her.
- Rewrite with suitable question tags:
- v) She is going home, _____
 - vi) Open the door, _____
- Rewrite with the proper form of the verb given:
- vii) I _____ when you called. (be + read)
 - viii) He _____ never _____ abroad. (have + travel)
- | | | | | | |
|--|--|---|---|---|--------|
| | | 8 | 3 | 3 | 8,9,11 |
|--|--|---|---|---|--------|

b)	Analyse the main concerns expressed by Ambedkar in Appeal to the Nation.	4	2	3	8,9,11
c)	How does Sarojini Naidu idealise the life of the fishermen in Coromandel Fishers?	4	4	3	8,9,11
6 a)	Organise a letter of application for the post of Junior Civil Engineer at Tata Projects Ltd. You are Ananya / Arun Sharma, a civil engineering graduate from IIT Guwahati, with one year of internship experience at Larsen & Toubro.	6	2	4	8,9,11
b)	Explain the three stages of a formal speech.	5	2	4	8,9,11
c)	Draft a farewell speech for the farewell ceremony of the senior football coach at the National Institute of Sports, Patiala. The Director, assistant coaches, players, and sports board officials are in attendance.	5	2	4	8,9,11

Unit - III

7 a)	Compose a paragraph in about 250 words on "My dream career and why I chose it"	6	3	4	8,9,11
b)	"The internet makes people less intelligent." Refute this statement in about 100 words.	5	3	4	8,9,11
c)	Fill in the blanks with the appropriate linkers given below: (Write the answers in the correct sequence) (Overall, because, on the other hand, consequently, in addition) Learning new languages is very beneficial. ____ (i) ____, it helps improve communication skills and broadens cultural understanding. ____ (ii) ____, some people find it difficult ____ (iii) ____ learning requires time and consistent effort. ____ (iv) ____, many give up too soon. ____ (v) ____, despite the challenges, acquiring a new language is rewarding and provides numerous personal and professional advantages that make the effort worthwhile.	5	2	3	8,9,11
8 a)	Compose a paragraph in about 250 words on "The role of technology in daily life."	6	3	4	8,9,11
b)	"Online education is more effective than traditional education." Refute this statement in about 100 words.	5	3	4	8,9,11
c)	Fill in the blanks with the appropriate linkers given below: (Write the answers in the correct sequence) (in the meantime, further, on account of, to sum up, despite) Climate change is a serious global issue. ____ (i) ____, many countries are working hard to reduce carbon emissions. ____ (ii) ____, pollution continues to rise ____ (iii) ____ rapid industrialisation. ____ (iv) ____, individuals can contribute by conserving energy and reducing waste. ____ (v) ____, while challenges remain, collective actions at both government and personal levels are vital to protect our planet for future generations.	5	2	3	8,9,11

BT* Bloom's Taxonomy, L* Level; CO* Course Outcome; PO* Program Outcome
